

Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad

Quiz 1

Communication Skills (LA 1760)

Maximum Marks: 50

Roll No.

General Instructions: please read very carefully:

- This question paper has 5 questions, A to E
- Use a blue/black pen
- Fill the correct answer as a bubble ●
- If two options are simultaneously chosen for one question, it will be marked wrong
- Read instructions very carefully and answer all questions
- Write your name and roll number
- No negative marking
- Use of mobile phones/internet not allowed

A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1X10=10 marks)

1. In academic/formal writing it is fine to be
 - a. Controversial and insulting
 - b. Biased and inflexible
 - c. Undecided yet informed
 - ☒ d. None of the above
2. For writing well informed formal articles, one should
 - a. Never repeat what has been said
 - ☒ b. Refer but with acknowledgements
 - c. Always and only refer to others
 - d. Try only self-referencing
3. While disagreeing with existing scholarship as you write an article, you must
 - ☒ a. Back your criticism with facts
 - b. Aggressively attack what you disagree with
 - c. Simply ignore what you disagree with
 - d. All of the above

4. When you write an academic article by foregrounding your own position on a topic, you should
- a. Strongly claim the validity of your arguments
 - ☒ b. Provide facts supporting the validity of your arguments ✓
 - c. Avoid all existing scholarly references on the topic
 - d. None of the above
5. In an academic article if you agree with existing scholarship but have more information to add, you should
- ☒ a. Acknowledge existing information ✗
 - b. Claim you are bridging a gap in scholarship
 - c. Provide your own take on the issue
 - d. All of the above
6. While writing a formal article, if you choose to agree and disagree simultaneously with existing scholarship you should
- a. Ignore the ideas you disagree with
 - ☒ b. Provide facts for your disagreement ✓
 - c. Never mention reasons for your disagreement
 - d. Provoke readers to disagree along with you
7. As you conclude a formal article, you should
- ☒ a. Reiterate your larger argument ✓
 - b. Never repeat yourself
 - c. Try using others' ideas to support your own
 - d. All of the above
8. A thesis statement helps you in
- a. Summarizing data you will reject
 - ☒ b. Summarizing your central argument ✓
 - c. Summarizing your data collection
 - d. None of the above
9. As you begin working on a formal piece of written communication that will be read by others, it is most important that you keep in mind
- a. Your own background
 - ☒ b. Who your reader is ✓
 - c. Whether you like the topic or not
 - d. None of the above
10. Historically, most human communication has been about
- ☒ a. Passing information ✓
 - b. Having fun
 - c. Keeping secrets
 - d. Forgetting incidents

B. From the following questions on communication in its various forms, choose the most appropriate answer (1X10=10 marks)

11. Academic plagiarism includes
- a. Unacknowledged copying
 - b. Duplication of others' ideas
 - c. Using others' ideas and claiming originality
 - ☒ d. All of the above
 - e. None of the above
12. To avoid plagiarism, one should
- a. Stop borrowing others' ideas
 - ☒ b. Use existing ideas with proper acknowledgement
 - c. Never acknowledge borrowing others' ideas
 - d. None of the above
13. While using AI for getting solutions for academic questions, it is important to remember that
- a. AI is programmed to respond to all questions
 - b. AI requires human scrutiny
 - c. AI is likely to have algorithmic bias
 - ☒ d. All of the above
 - e. None of the above
14. One of the most important things scholars need to do with AI is
- ☒ a. Ensure that inclusive and unbiased data is used
 - b. Ensure that all AI systems are developed in Western laboratories alone
 - c. Ensure that only highly technically trained individuals use AI
 - d. All of the above
15. When using AI for academic writing, one must
- a. Ensure attribution of source
 - b. Double check against bias and inaccuracy
 - c. Never copy without acknowledgement
 - ☒ d. All of the above
16. One of the main concerns with using AI for mitigating human problems is
- ☒ a. Data generated can be faulty and inaccurate
 - b. Data generated can be from global sources
 - c. Data generated is available very fast
 - d. All of the above

17. To be an empathetic communicator, one needs to
- a. Try correcting the other person's mistakes
 - b. Amuse the other person
 - ☒ c. Try being in the other person's shoes ✓
 - d. Try avoiding the other person
18. In effective communication, one needs to be
- a. Firm and aggressive
 - b. Firm and submissive
 - c. Firm and amusing ✓
 - ☒ d. Firm and polite
19. In formal communication, the best way to handle criticism is to
- ☒ a. Distinguish between hurtful and helpful criticism ✓
 - b. Aggressively fight back to stop the critic
 - c. Reject all criticism and keep working
 - d. All of the above
20. Humor in formal communication
- a. Should be avoided at all costs
 - b. Should always be present ✓
 - ☒ c. Should be used to diffuse unpleasantness
 - d. Should be used to ridicule others

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2X5=10 marks)

Saving energy means saving money. Homeowners and renters know this basic fact, but they often don't know what kinds of adjustments they can make in their homes and apartments that will result in savings.

For those willing to spend some time and money to reap long-term energy savings, an energy audit is the way to go. An energy auditor will come into your home and assess its energy efficiency. The auditor will pinpoint areas of your home that use the most energy and offer solutions to lower your energy use and costs. Trained energy auditors know what to look for and can locate a variety of flaws that may be resulting in energy inefficiency, including inadequate insulation, construction flaws, and uneven heat distribution.

There are quicker and less costly measures that can be taken as well. One way to save money is to replace incandescent lights with fluorescents. This can result in a savings of more than 50% on your monthly lighting costs.

When it's time to replace old appliances, it's wise to spend a bit more for an energy-efficient model, and be sure that you are taking advantage of energy-saving settings already on your current refrigerator, dishwasher, washing machine, or dryer.

Windows provide another opportunity to cut your energy costs. Caulk old windows that might be leaky to prevent drafts, and choose double-paned windows if you're building an addition or replacing old windows.

Most areas of your home or apartment offer opportunities to save energy and money. The results are significant and are well worth the effort.

21. Which two main organizational schemes can be identified in this passage?

- a. hierarchical order and order by topic
- ☒ b. order by topic and cause and effect
- c. hierarchical order and chronological order
- d. chronological order and compare and contrast

22. Which of the following ideas is NOT included in this passage?

- a. You can reduce your \$130 monthly lighting costs to \$65 by using fluorescent bulbs instead of incandescent.
- b. Double-paned windows can cut energy costs.
- ☒ c. Your local energy company will send an energy auditor at your request.
- d. Some appliances have energy-saving settings.

23. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

- ☒ a. There are many things a homeowner or renter can do to save energy and money.
- b. Hiring an energy auditor will save energy and money.
- c. Homeowners and renters don't know what they can do to save energy and money.
- d. Replacing windows and light bulbs are well worth the effort and cost.

24. According to the passage, which of the following would an energy auditor NOT do?

- a. Check for construction flaws.
- b. Look for problems with heat distribution.
- c. Offer solutions to lower your energy costs.
- ☒ d. Locate a variety of flaws that may result in energy inefficiency and fix them.

25. According to the passage, double-paned windows

- ☒ a. are energy efficient.
- b. should only be used as replacement windows.
- c. should only be used in new additions to homes.
- d. will lower your heating costs by 50%.

31. What is the main idea of the passage?
- a. Our homes are full of contaminants.
 - b. Our allergies are caused by chemicals found in the home. ✓
 - c. All plants release moisture in the home.
 - ☒ d. Certain plants can purify the home of many harmful chemicals.
32. According to the passage, when a few harmful chemicals combine, they can
- ☒ a. cause us to experience allergies.
 - b. cause a monumental task for homeowners. ✗
 - c. contribute to a syndrome called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity.
 - d. contribute to photosynthesis in plants.
33. The passage indicates that research
- ☒ a. has only been conducted using specific plants.
 - b. has only been conducted by NASA. ✓
 - c. has not identified the sources of these chemical impurities.
 - d. has only benefited long term space exploration.
34. The passage infers a relationship between the antiquity of ferns and palms and their ability to
- a. live long.
 - ☒ b. purify the air. ✓
 - c. grow leaves that live long.
 - d. react successfully in research experiments.
35. A good title for this passage is
- a. Research in the New Millennium. ✓
 - b. Home Dangers.
 - ☒ c. Common Houseplants May Purify Your Home.
 - d. NASA Experiment Finds the Cure.

30. The passage tells us that Mesoamerican pyramids were
- a. Very strong in their architecture
 - b. Took a lot of time to build
 - ☒ c. Were not meant to survive very long
 - d. Were made of moss

E. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2X5=10 marks)

During those barren winter months, with windows overlooking long-dead gardens, leafless trees, and lawns that seem to have an ashy look about them, nothing soothes the jangled nerves more than the vibrant green of plants surrounding the living spaces of one's home. People browse through garden stores just to get a whiff of chlorophyll and to choose a plant or two to bring spring back into their winter-gray lives.

Now there is even more of a need for "the green," in light of recent articles warning us of the hazards of chemicals that we, ourselves, introduce into our homes. Each time we bring clothes home from the cleaners, we release those chemicals into the closed-in air of our dwellings. Every cleanser releases its own assortment of fumes. Some of the chemicals are formaldehyde, chlorine, benzene, styrene, etc. Read the labels on many home products, the ingredients aren't even listed! During the winter, when those same windows are shut tight, we breathe in these chemicals—causing symptoms much like allergies. In fact, most people probably dismiss the effects of these chemicals simply as a flare up of some allergy or other. The truth is that we are experiencing a syndrome that is called Multiple Chemical Sensitivity. Now, what has this got to do with green plants? Everything healthy! Research has been conducted with two types of plants that have actually removed much of these harmful chemicals from the air.

The two plants that seem to be the best bet for ridding one's home of such chemicals are ferns and palms. These plants release moisture as part of photosynthesis and, as they do, pull chemicals from the air into their leaves. Even NASA has conducted some greenhouse experiments for long-term space exploration. Within hours, their plants [palms] had removed almost all traces of formaldehyde in the room. Both species of plants are ancient, dating back more than a hundred million years. Another trait they share is that they both live long lives, 100 years or more. This we expect from trees, but ferns and palms are plants; plants that can grow to 65 feet in the proper setting! Even their individual leaves live for one to two years [ferns] and one to nine years [palms]. Perhaps it is their primal qualities that have contributed to their ability to purify their environment.

30. Charles, aware of his susceptibility to gum disease, is diligent about flossing.

- a. uncomfortable
- b. excited
- ☒ c. thorough
- d. ambivalent

E. Find the most appropriate pair of words following the analogy given in the question (1X10=10 marks)

31. LAYER : TIER

- a. section : segment
- b. dais : speaker
- ☒ c. curtain : stage
- d. chapter : verse
- ☐ e. cotton : bale

32. METROPOLITAN : URBAN

- ☒ a. bucolic : rural
- b. sleepy : nocturnal
- c. agricultural : cow
- d. autumn : harvest
- e. agrarian : generous

33. TEACHER : SCHOOL

- a. actor : role
- b. mechanic : engine
- c. jockey : horse
- ☒ d. judge : courthouse
- e. author : book

34. PERSIAN : CAT

- a. alligator : crocodile
- b. zebra : reptile
- ☒ c. parakeet : bird
- d. rat : marsupial
- e. fly : bee

35. RUN : JOG

- a. trot : race
- b. swim : dive
- c. dance : ballet
- d. juggle : bounce
- ☒ e. rain : drizzle

d. A few white students at the university were pleased that Autherine Lucy was a student there.

C. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2X5=10 marks)

Saving energy means saving money. Homeowners and renters know this basic fact, but they often don't know what kinds of adjustments they can make in their homes and apartments that will result in savings.

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24. Although Zachary is much too inexperienced for the managerial position, he is a willful young man and *obdurately* refuses to withdraw his application.

- a. foolishly
- b. reluctantly
- c. constantly
- ☒ d. stubbornly

25. His neighbor's *superficial* remarks trivialized the property line dispute and infuriated Malcolm.

- a. enraged
- ☒ b. petty
- c. insulting
- d. misleading

26. When Katya refused to lie to her parents about where she was spending the night, she was completely *ostracized* by her usually loyal friends, who had never shunned her before.

- ☒ a. excluded
- b. hurt
- c. cheered
- d. helped

27. Her fashion sense was usually described as *flamboyant*, but on the night of the party, Tanya's outfit was *uncharacteristically* modest.

- ☒ a. impeccable
- b. showy
- c. sloppy
- d. unassuming

28. Mr. Powers was so *gullible* that he believed even the most outlandish excuses of his *insincere* employees.

- a. intelligent
- ☒ b. naive
- c. dishonest
- d. critical

29. You cannot become a certified teacher without completing the *prerequisite* student teaching assignment.

- ☒ a. required
- b. optional
- c. preferred
- d. advisable

18. Which of the following best expresses the main idea of this passage?

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D. Vocabulary: Read the following sentences and try to choose the best definition for the italicized word by searching for context clues in the sentence (1X10=10 marks)

21. The designer window treatments in her house, installed 17 years ago, were *outmoded*.

- a. unnecessary
- b. pointless
- ☒ c. out-of-date
- d. worthless

22. Although the professor's lectures were regarded by many as so *wearisome* that they regularly put students to sleep, he ignored all criticism and refused to make any changes.

- a. modest
- b. unpleasant
- ☒ c. boring
- d. objectionable

23. The baseball player's malice toward the referee was revealed in his *spiteful* remarks to the media, which almost ruined the referee's career.

- ☒ a. vindictive
- b. crazy
- c. rude
- d. unpleasant

dormitory. White students rioted in protest of her admission, and the federal government had to assume command of the Alabama National Guard in order to protect her. Nonetheless, on her first day in class, Autherine bravely took a seat in the front row. She remembers being surprised that the professor of the class appeared not to notice she was even in class. Later, she would appreciate his seeming indifference, as he was one of only a few professors to speak out in favor of her right to attend the university.

For protection, Autherine was taken in and out of classroom buildings by the back door and driven from class to class by an assistant to the university president. The students continued to riot, and one day, the windshield of the car she was in was broken. University officials suspended her, saying it was for her own safety. When her attorney issued a statement in her name protesting her suspension, the university used it as grounds for expelling her for insubordination. Although she never finished her education at the University of Alabama, Autherine Lucy's courage was an inspiration to African-American students who followed her lead and desegregated universities all over the United States.

11. According to the passage, what did Autherine Lucy do on her first day at the University of Alabama?

- a. She moved into a dormitory.
- ☒ b. She sat in the front row of her class.
- c. She became terrified of the white rioters.
- d. She was befriended by an assistant to the university president.

12. Based on the information in the passage, which of the following best describes Autherine Lucy?

- a. quiet and shy
- ☒ b. courageous and determined
- c. clever and amusing
- d. overly dramatic

13. When she began classes at the university, Autherine Lucy expected to

- ☒ a. stand out from the other students.
- b. have the support of the university faculty.
- c. join an African-American organization for protection.
- d. be ridiculed by the professors.

14. Autherine Lucy never graduated from the University of Alabama because she

- a. moved to another state.
- b. transferred to another university.
- c. dropped out because of pressure from other students.
- ☒ d. was expelled for insubordination.

15. According to the passage, which of the following is true?

- a. The Alabama National Guard is normally under the command of the U.S. Army.
- b. In 1956, the only segregated university in the United States was in Alabama.
- ☒ c. Autherine Lucy was escorted to and from class by the university president's assistant.

- ☒ All of the above
- e. None of the above

5. A well-written resume should definitely contain
- a. Summary of one's childhood experiences
 - ☒ b. Summary of one's most significant qualifications
 - c. Summary of one's family income
 - d. All of the above

6. While taking letters of reference for the resume, one should
- a. Never disturb referees by contacting them in advance
 - ☒ b. Choose referees who have a fair and positive idea of one's credentials
 - c. Choose referees who are next of kin for authenticity
 - d. None of the above

7. Rogerian argument in meetings brings about
- a. A reconciliation between entirely opposing ideals
 - b. A situation promoting the corporate rat race
 - ☒ c. A platform for meaningful business negotiations
 - d. A situation leading to creation of trade unions

8. According to the Harvard Negotiation Project, Principled Negotiation leads to
- a. Emotionally driven judgement on official issues
 - b. Victory of one party over another
 - c. Focus on one party's interest over another
 - ☒ d. Possible options being created for mutual gain

9. To be a productive participant in a business meeting, one should be
- a. A vocal critic of all ideas presented
 - b. An active social agent who exposes confidential issues
 - ☒ c. A supportive and perceptive listener
 - d. All of the above

10. An official memo or report is usually meant for
- ☒ a. Only the scientific advisers of an organization
 - b. All office workers who regularly read newspapers
 - c. Only the regular clients of an organization
 - d. The manager and other non-expert readers in an organization

B. Read the following passage and choose the most appropriate answers for the questions that follow (2X5=10 marks)

On February 3, 1956, Aurtherine Lucy became the first African-American student to attend the University of Alabama, although the dean of women refused to allow Aurtherine to live in a university

Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad

Quiz 2

Communication Skills (LA 1760)

Maximum Marks: 50

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Roll No.: _____

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A. Carefully read the following questions on academic/professional communication and choose the most appropriate answer (1X10=10 marks)

1. Official meetings should ideally be convened for
 - a. Brainstorming on pertinent topics
 - b. Creating official network within one's organization
 - ☒ c. Finding carefully planned solution through consensus
 - d. None of the above
2. Where agenda in official meetings is concerned, it should
 - a. Be left entirely flexible and changeable
 - ☒ b. Be circulated in advance
 - c. Be kept confidential till meeting begins
 - d. All of the above
3. Minutes of meetings are crucial because
 - a. They help sticking to the time limit set for a meeting
 - b. They provide a job for the minute taker
 - ☒ c. They help avoid confusion once the meeting is over
 - d. None of the above
4. During virtual meetings it is important to
 - a. Keep presentations ready in advance
 - b. Maintain composure in one's voice and tone
 - c. Stick to the main point of discussion

36. SKEIN : YARN

- a. squeeze : lemon
- b. fire : coal
- ☒ c. ream : paper
- d. tree : lumber
- e. plow : acre

37. TAILOR : SUIT

- a. scheme : agent
- ☒ b. edit : manuscript
- c. revise : writer
- d. mention : opinion
- e. implode : building

38. CONDUCTOR : ORCHESTRA

- a. jockey : mount
- b. thrasher : hay
- c. driver : tractor
- ☒ d. skipper : crew
- e. painter : house

39. JAUNDICE : LIVER

- ☒ a. rash : skin
- b. dialysis : kidney
- c. smog : lung
- d. valentine : heart
- e. imagination : brain

40. COBBLER : SHOE

- a. jockey : horse
- ☒ b. contractor : building
- c. mason : stone
- d. cowboy : boot
- e. potter : paint